



# Money Memories interview sheet

A younger family member asks an older one what money meant in their life, and listens. Choose a handful of questions; one good story can fill the hour. Young children can ask three questions and be done.

Storyteller \_\_\_\_\_ Interviewer \_\_\_\_\_ Date \_\_\_\_\_

**Before you begin, the storyteller decides.** The interview will be kept as: ☐ notes ☐ a recording ☐ nothing

It may be shared beyond the family: ☐ yes ☐ yes, without names ☐ no. You can skip any question and stop at any time.

## Growing up

- What did your parents do for work?
- Did people swap things or help each other instead of paying?

## First work

- What was your first job? How were you paid, and how often?
- What did you do with your first wages?

## Prices

- How much did a loaf of bread, a coffee or a bus ticket cost when you were young?
- What did a house cost, compared to a year's wages?

**Then and now.** Afterwards, compare one remembered price with today's.

|                         | Then  | Now   |
|-------------------------|-------|-------|
| Item                    | _____ | _____ |
| Price                   | _____ | _____ |
| Hours of work to buy it | _____ | _____ |



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### Hard times

- Was there a time when money was very short? What did your family do?
- Do you remember when the currency changed? What happened to people's savings?

### Trust

- Where did your family keep its savings: at home, in a bank, in the post office, in gold, in land?
- Did anyone in the family ever lose money? How?

### Debt

- Did your family ever borrow? Who from?
- Was debt thought of as normal, or as something shameful?

### Looking back

- What is the best thing you ever did with money?
- What do you wish you had known about money when you were my age?

**For the chronicle.** Ask: what should this family never forget? Write one line to copy into the chronicle (sheet 05).

**Tips for interviewers:** listen more than you ask. "Tell me more about that" is often the best question. Don't correct or argue. If the storyteller becomes upset, stop, and let them decide whether to go on.